

Philipp Hilbert. *Digital banking product owner, SME channels.*

Positioning, SME-focused product leader with 13 years of regulated-industry delivery, from backlog to production, across mobile, web, and platform teams.

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Dear Hiring Team,

Mashreq's ambition to lead digital SME banking across the UAE, Egypt, and Pakistan is a genuinely hard problem, and the job description makes it clear the company understands why: owning a shared platform across three regulatory environments, three market contexts, and two channels while still keeping customer journeys consistent and reusable is structurally different from running a single-country product. That challenge is what drew me to this role.

My background is in product ownership across regulated industries with real accountability, meaning I have held the roadmap, the backlog, the release, and the live-service performance, not handed them off after delivery. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, managing a cross-functional team of fifteen engineers and data scientists, introducing GitOps delivery that cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes, and redirecting the entire product strategy based on instrumented workflow data. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I ran a national labour-market analytics platform as Product Manager and Deputy IT Security Officer simultaneously, migrating a bare-metal system to containers, launching a full UI relaunch, and introducing Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual ETL effort. Both roles required coordinating across engineering, data science, compliance, and executive stakeholders in environments where a mistake in production had visible consequences.

The SME-specific demand in this role, self-service adoption, digital engagement, customer effort reduction, maps closely to work I have done in adjacent contexts. At CLINET Platforms I took a mobile patient app team that could not deliver its roadmap and cut the backlog to the top ten percent of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I restructured an eighteen-person delivery organisation to stop engineer attrition and rebuild client trust, then shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. At Kvitt Payment Solutions I built a P2P mobile payments product from zero and took it to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem. The common thread is end-to-end ownership: I stay accountable from the discovery interview through the incident postmortem.

I am an EU citizen currently based in Berlin, and I am actively targeting the UAE. I am prepared to relocate to Dubai for this role and to work fully on-site. The multi-market scope across UAE, Egypt, and Pakistan is a feature, not a complication, for me. My experience coordinating multinational engineering and stakeholder groups across time zones and regulatory contexts means I have already built the operating rhythm this kind of cross-border product governance requires.

I would be glad to walk through any part of my experience in more detail or to discuss how I would approach the first ninety days in the role.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
